

Figure 9: Extension showing current cpu temps

That sums up my must-have GNOME extensions. There are many other useful extensions like the workspace switcher, Gmail notifier and more. I'll leave the rest for you to discover. The GNOME extension website may not be the best, but it offers a boatload of extensions that might be handy for you.

Creating your own extensions

You can create your own extensions, though the dearth of documentation makes the job a little tough. Adding the changes in settings and APIs can even sour the experience. Anyway, that shouldn't stop us from trying. You need some knowledge of JavaScript and GNOME APIs. To begin, in a terminal run the following command:

```
gnome-shell-extension-tool -create-extension
```

You'll be asked a few questions like the name of the extension, description and unique ID (UUID). After these steps, the tool will create the files needed for your extension, under `~/.local/share/gnome-shell/extensions/<your_extension>`. For example, I created an 'LFY' extension with the UUID `LFY@shashwat-desktop`, and a folder was created with this name in place of `your_extension` in the above path. In the directory, you will notice three files by default:

- `extension.js`: The main JavaScript extension file that holds all the code for an extension to work.
- `metadata.json`: A JavaScript Object Notation file that holds the metadata that you entered while creating the extension.
- `stylesheet.css`: Provides the look and feel for your extension. All additional styling is in this file.

Once you are done, simply restart the GNOME Shell and an icon will appear on the top. Upon clicking it, you may display several messages.

If you want to develop an extension, there aren't many live examples, though GNOME has compiled a decent getting-



Figure 11: Advanced Settings in user menu



Figure 10: To-do extension—list of tasks

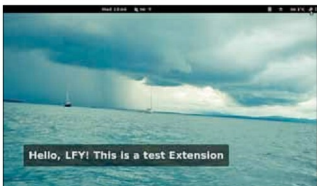


Figure 12: Test extension created with the GNOME extension tool

started page: <https://live.gnome.org/GnomeShell/Extensions>. You may also want to get through the GObject used by GNOME developers to call data back and forth.

Removing or managing extensions

You can disable extensions using `gnome-tweak-tool` or the GNOME extension website (visit <https://extensions.gnome.org/local/>).

You can use the extension preferences located under *Settings Center* (provided you have installed the *Advance Settings Center* mentioned earlier) or simply launch it by typing `gnome-shell-extension-prefs`.

You can remove extensions either by removing their folder from `~/.local/share/gnome-shell/<extension>` or simply clicking the *Remove* button on the GNOME extension site.

Some closing words...

The GNOME desktop provides a stable experience, but the missing features are a setback for both developers and mainstream users. GNOME has come up with extensions to try and remedy the problem, but real extension development